

sale of all their assets would yield only a small fraction of the total debt. They then asked each creditor not to join the bankruptcy action on the promise (in writing) that they would repay all debts in total at a future date.

This action was taken against the counsel of their attorney, who recommended that they place all debts in the bankruptcy and clear them. He said they could choose to repay the deficiencies later, if and when they had the funds. Bud and Sandi decided not to take his advice, because they thought it should be the choice of the creditor to take what was available immediately or trust them to repay later.

Because of the loan defaults as a result of the bankruptcy, Bud also owed nearly \$100,000 in taxes to the IRS. Under a rule called Forgiveness of Debt, most of the unrecovered loan balances were declared income and, as such, were subject to taxes, interest, and penalties.

Needless to say, Bud and Sandi felt like the weight of the world had been dropped on them. But they remembered Romans 13:1, 6–7: “Everyone must submit himself to the governing authorities, for there is no authority except that which God has established. The authorities that exist have been established by God.... This is also why you pay taxes, for the authorities are God’s servants, who give their full time to governing. Give everyone what you owe him: If you owe taxes, pay taxes; if revenue, then revenue; if respect, then respect; if honor, then honor.”

From that evening on, they made a commitment to pray that the IRS agent who was working on their case would come to know Jesus as his Savior. And they prayed that God would ultimately provide the funds to retire all their debts.

Three years passed as Bud and Sandi continued to pay on obligations that accumulated thousands of dollars in interest each year. Fortunately, Bud did product sales, and his annual income increased nicely. They were able to accelerate payments to the bank and to the IRS, and they also increased the amount they gave to the